physiological changes that occur in fertile women for the purpose of sexual reproduction. The menstrual cycle is controlled by the endocrine system.

The hormones involved in the menstrual cycle

The mechanism is controlled by the hypothalamus.

1. Gonodotrophin releasing hormone.
2. FSH-Folicular Stimulating Hormone.
3. LH - Luteinizing Hormone.
4. Progesterone and
5. Estrogen.

Menstrual cycle can be explained in two cycles which occur concurrently

1. The ovarian cycle and
2. The uterine cycle



- Female literacy is only 54%, and women lack the empowerment to take decisions, including decision to use reproductive health services.
- The World Health Organization (WHO) estimates that, of 536,000 maternal deaths occurring globally each year, 136,000 take place in India, despite the safe motherhood policies and programmatic initiatives at the national level.
- In 2015, it is estimated that about 800 girls and women died every day as a result of pregnancy and child birth-related complications though there is a decline in worldwide mortality rates.

- The Ovarian Cycle consists of
  a. The follicular phase , ovulation and
  b. The luteal phase
- The Uterine Cycle consists of
  a. menstrual phase
  b. The proliferative phase and
  c. The secretory phase

1. Ovarian cycle

a. Follicular phase: The hypothalamus released gonadotrophin releasing hormone, which stimulates anterior pituitary gland and secrets follicle stimulating hormone (FSH). All the follicles degenerated except one to mature into a large graffian follicle. The follicle ruptures and releases an ovum into the peritoneal cavity.

b. The **luteal phase:** Begins with ovulation. The body temperature drops of then rises by 0.5 to 1 around the time of ovulation. Corpus luteum is formed from follicle cells that remain in the ovary following ovulation. Corpus luteum secretes oestrogen and progesterone during the remaining 14 days of cycle. Corpus luteum degenerates, if the ovum is not fertilized.

2. Uterine or Menstrual cycle

a. **Menstrual phase:** It is characterized by vaginal bleeding and lasts for 4-6 days. Physiologically this is the terminal phase of the menstrual cycle. The endometrium sheds up to the basal layer along with the blood from capillaries and the unfertilized ovum. Bleeding occurs when the coiled arteries return to a state of construction.

b. **Proliferative phase:** This phase follows menstruation and lasts until ovulation. The

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